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PATHFINDER

**Unlocking the Potential of YouTH on AI Learning For active transition to
employment through DEMocratic paRticipation**

Deliverable D5.1

Research Agenda
and Action Plan
for Serbia

Young Researchers of Serbia (YRS)

28 July 2026

EVENT DESCRIPTION SHEET

PROJECT	
Participant:	[4] – Young Researchers of Serbia (YRS)
PIC number:	946514167
Project name and acronym:	Unlocking the Potential of Youth on AI Learning for Active Transition to Employment through Democratic Participation - PATHFINDER

EVENT DESCRIPTION			
Event number:	WP5		
Event name:	Participatory research in Serbia		
Type:	Mutual learning		
In situ/online:	In-situ		
Location:	Serbia, Niš; Serbia, Belgrade		
Date(s):	8 July 2026, 17 July 2026, 20 July 2026		
Website(s) (if any):	N/A		
Participants			
Female:	26		
Male:	22		
Non-binary:	/		
From country 1 [Serbia]:	(41)		
From country 2 [Spain]:	(1)		
From country 3 [Cyprus]:	(1)		
From country 4 [Moldova]:	(1)		
From country 5 [Romania]:	(1)		
From country 6 [Norway]:	(1)		
From country 7 [Tunisia]:	(1)		
From country 8 [Azerbaijan]:	(1)		
Total number of participants:	48	From total number of countries:	8

Description

Provide a short description of the event and its activities.

As part of WP5, Young Researchers in Serbia organized **national youth-employer dialogue events**, titled "**AI START: Youth, Artificial Intelligence and the Pathways to Employment**" brought together young people, representatives of employers, job info centers, civil society organisations and AI experts to discuss the implications of artificial intelligence for youth employment and the future of work. To ensure equal access and broad participation, particularly among young people from rural areas and marginalized groups, two events were organized: **one in Belgrade and one in Niš**. The second event was held in Niš, the largest city in the South and East Serbia region, which is among the country's least economically developed areas. This approach helped reduce geographical barriers to participation and enabled the project to reach young people who might otherwise have limited access to such opportunities.

As added value, during the **International Student Week in Belgrade**, one **small focus group** was organized, gathering students from diverse backgrounds and countries, aiming to tackle their perspectives and awareness regarding AI, skills and preparedness, employer experiences. As an added value activity, a small focus group was organized during the International Student Week in Belgrade. The discussion brought together students from diverse educational, cultural, and national backgrounds to explore their perspectives on artificial intelligence, assess their awareness of the skills required in an AI-driven labour market, and gather insights into their experiences and expectations regarding employers and future employment.

The events in Belgrade and Niš formed part of the national participatory dialogue foreseen under the PATHFINDER methodology. It built on the common baseline survey implemented across the five partner countries (Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Greece, Serbia and Slovakia) to young people aged 18–30 and employers before the dialogue events. **The survey** was implemented in each national language using a shared questionnaire to ensure comparability across participating countries. It collected evidence on awareness and use of AI, perceptions of AI and employment, groups at risk of exclusion, skills and preparedness, employer experiences, and priorities for future action. Responses were subsequently harmonised into a common dataset to enable cross-country comparison. In total survey gathered 206 responses from young people and 142 responses from employers, **while Serbia's contribution was 34 youth representative responses (mostly coming from rural/undeveloped areas) and 11 employer's responses.**

The structure of the events combined the presentation of baseline research findings with participatory activities designed to foster dialogue and identify priorities. Following an interactive exercise on participants' perceptions of AI, mixed stakeholder groups explored the opportunities, risks, and challenges of AI in the labour market, analysed key issues using the problem tree methodology, and prioritised the most pressing challenges through a structured voting exercise. The event concluded with group presentations, validation of key findings, and the identification of priority areas to inform future project activities and evidence-based policy recommendations on youth employment, skills development, and AI governance.

Version / Revision History

Version	Date	Author / Organisation	Description of changes
0.1	[23/07/2026]	Jovana Jović, Young Researchers of Serbia	First draft / table of contents
0.2	[29/07/2026]	Tijana Ljubenović, Young Researchers of Serbia	Internal review
0.3	[31/07/2026]	Tanja Petrović, Young Researchers of Serbia	Final version submitted



Acknowledgement



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Disclaimer

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Summary

This report presents the findings of the Serbian participatory research conducted under Work Package 5 (WP5) of the PATHFINDER project (*Unlocking the Potential of Youth on AI Learning for Active Transition to Employment through Democratic Participation*). The research explored how Artificial Intelligence (AI) is influencing young people's transition to employment and examined the opportunities, challenges and skills needed to support inclusive and responsible AI-driven labour market transitions in Serbia.

The research adopted a mixed-methods participatory approach, combining a national baseline survey, focus group with 7 international students and structured participatory youth-employer dialogue involving 41 participants, including young people, representatives of employers, AI experts and other labour market stakeholders based in Serbia. The dialogue was built upon the survey findings through a series of interactive activities, including a World Café, Root Cause Analysis, participatory voting and collective reflection, enabling participants to interpret quantitative evidence, share experiences and jointly identify priorities for future action.

The findings show that AI has become an integral part of young people's learning and work practices, while employers are increasingly integrating AI tools into their operations. Both groups acknowledge that AI is reshaping the skills needed for labour market participation. However, significant challenges remain, including young people's readiness to use AI effectively, limited access to practical AI learning opportunities, decline in entry-level positions as AI increasingly automates routine tasks, persistent digital inequalities, and the education system's ability to respond to rapid technological change. In addition, one of the key conclusions of the dialogue was that awareness and critical understanding of AI's broader impact remain generally low. These findings highlight the need for a more accessible, inclusive, and practice-oriented AI education system, supported by stronger digital literacy, critical thinking, ethical awareness, and policy driven approaches.

The report contributes to the wider objectives of the PATHFINDER project by providing evidence that will inform future project activities, including Youth Skills Labs, Career Days, transnational dialogue and policy recommendations. Moreover, it emphasizes the value of participatory research in ensuring that young people and labour market stakeholders play an active role in shaping evidence-based responses to AI driven labour market transformation.

Keywords: Artificial Intelligence (AI); youth employment; AI impact on job market; participatory research; labour market transitions; AI literacy; basic digital literacy; adaptability to AI tools; critical thinking; AI policy regulation; AI ethics; education.

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1. Introduction

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is transforming labour markets and reshaping the skills required for successful transitions to employment. As these developments accelerate, there is an increasing need to ensure that young people are prepared to navigate AI-driven change while promoting inclusive, ethical and human-centred approaches to technological innovation.

This report presents the findings of the Serbian participatory and Research Agenda and Action Plan undertaken as part of WP5 of the PATHFINDER project, which identify priority areas for future research and practical actions to support inclusive AI-driven labour market transitions.

1.1 Participatory Research Overview

Upon mapping of all relevant stakeholders and target groups, the first phase of the participatory research included baseline survey by providing an opportunity to explore how young people, employers, and other key stakeholders perceive the impact of artificial intelligence on youth employment and the future of work in Serbia. While the survey generated quantitative evidence on emerging trends and attitudes, the following participatory process enabled participants to collectively interpret these findings, discuss their underlying causes, and identify priority areas for future research and policy action.

The research combined national baseline survey findings with a structured dialogue process that encouraged active participation, knowledge sharing, and collaborative problem-solving. By bringing together diverse stakeholder perspectives, the process generated qualitative insights that both validated and enriched the survey results, while laying the foundation for the Serbia-specific research agenda and action plan.

1.2 Objectives

The **overall objective** of this phase was to **deepen the understanding of how artificial intelligence is influencing youth employment, skills needs, and labour market transitions in Serbia by combining quantitative evidence with participatory dialogue**. Building on the baseline survey, the research sought to identify the opportunities, risks, and policy challenges associated with AI from the perspectives of young people, employers, and other relevant stakeholders, while generating evidence to inform future research and policy recommendations.

The participatory approach was designed to position young people not only as respondents but as active contributors to the research process. Through structured dialogue, collaborative analysis, and collective prioritization of challenges and solutions, participants were actively involved in interpreting evidence, validating findings, and co-creating recommendations. This approach recognized young people as co-creators of knowledge whose experiences and perspectives are essential for developing evidence-based and inclusive responses to the changing world of work.

The participatory research conducted in Serbia addressed six interconnected objectives in line with the PATHFINDER methodological framework and the project's established research priorities.

- Validate baseline survey findings by exploring how participants interpreted the quantitative results and whether these reflected their lived experiences of AI and labour market change.
- Examine the implications of AI for employment and workplaces, including its impact on work organisation, employment opportunities, organisational practices, and future labour market developments.
- Identify the skills and competencies needed for successful participation in AI-supported labour markets, with a focus on AI literacy, critical thinking, human-centred skills, and related education and training needs.
- Assess the risks of exclusion for vulnerable young people, examining how educational, economic, and geographical inequalities affect access to AI-related opportunities and inclusive labour market transitions.
- Generate evidence to inform the PATHFINDER Research Agenda by identifying research priorities through collaborative analysis and validation grounded in participants' experiences.
- Strengthen dialogue among young people, employers, and labour market stakeholders to promote mutual learning, exchange of perspectives, and the co-creation of recommendations for future project activities.

1.3 Baseline survey

The baseline survey constituted the first stage of the participatory research process and provided the quantitative evidence base for the national dialogues in all partner's countries. In Serbia, the survey was conducted online in end-May 2026 reaching two target groups: young people aged 18–30 (mostly from rural /undeveloped areas) and employers.

Two complementary questionnaires were developed in English language by the project partners and further translated in the languages of the project countries, as well as in Serbian.

The survey explored participants' awareness and use of artificial intelligence, perceptions of its impact on employment and skills, preparedness for an AI-driven labour market, barriers to skills development, and expectations regarding future labour market changes. The employer survey additionally examined organisational use of AI, recruitment practices, and perceptions of young people's employability and skills.

Across all PATHFINDER partner countries, the survey collected a total of 206 responses from young people and 142 responses from employers. **Serbia contributed with 34 responses from young people, the majority of whom were from rural and underdeveloped areas, and 11 responses from employers.**

The baseline survey served two complementary purposes. First, it generated a common evidence base that is comparable across all participating countries in the PATHFINDER project. Second, Serbia's findings were presented at the beginning of the participatory dialogue events to stimulate discussion, encourage participants to reflect on the survey results, and provide an evidence-based starting point for the interactive activities that followed.

1.4 Participatory dialogue event design

In line with participatory action research principles, the event is designed to ensure that all participants, particularly young people, have meaningful opportunities to contribute to knowledge production and decision-making. It was designed as a structured, evidence-informed process that combined presentation of research findings with collaborative analysis and collective reflection, following already developed Research framework for all partners. The structure of the event reflected the sequential logic of participatory research processes identified in the Child- and Youth-Friendly Participatory Action Research Toolkit, which emphasizes the progression from issue identification to prioritisation, analysis, and collective planning.

The programme began with a plenary session introducing the key findings of the baseline survey on both PATHFINDER and national level, providing participants with a shared evidence base for subsequent discussions (*step 1 – evidence based framing*). As an added value to the events, an AI expert was invited to raise participants' awareness of the impact of artificial intelligence on the labour market. The session enhanced participants' understanding of AI, encouraged critical reflection on its ethical implications, and contributed to the development of essential competencies that can improve young people's readiness for an evolving labour market. This was followed by a series of facilitated plenary and small-group activities in which youth participants identified and mapped the main opportunities and challenges associated with artificial intelligence and the future of work, and through World Café format, jointly with representatives of employers and AI experts analysed the underlying causes of priority issues and prioritised the challenges requiring the greatest policy attention (*step 2 - participatory identification and mapping of issues, step 3 - analysis of root causes, step 4 - participatory prioritisation*). The event concluded with plenary presentations, collective discussion, and validation of the identified priorities and recommendations (*step 5 - collective reflection and co-interpretation*). Last session included a final reflection and the completion of the European Commission evaluation survey.

2. Main Findings

The Serbian participatory research represents the first stage of PATHFINDER's evidence-generation process, establishing the empirical foundation for the project's subsequent activities and outputs. Through a combination of quantitative and qualitative research, Work Package 5 aims to provide an understanding of how AI is reshaping youth employment across participating countries while ensuring that the experiences and perspectives of young people and employers directly inform future research, capacity-building activities and policy development. The survey itself explored seven interconnected dimensions of AI-driven labour market transformation: awareness and use of AI, perceptions of AI and employment, groups most at risk of exclusion, skills and preparedness, barriers to AI learning, employer experiences, and priorities for future action.

The evidence generated through this phase provided the basis for the Serbian Research Agenda and Action Plan, shaping the project's transnational comparative analysis, and supporting the design of subsequent project activities,

including Youth Skills Labs, Career Days, the Transnational Dialogue on AI and Youth Employability, and the final policy recommendations.

Baseline survey main findings

Across all PATHFINDER partner countries, the survey collected a total of 206 responses from young people and 142 responses from employers. **Serbia contributed with 34 responses from young people, the majority of whom were from rural and underdeveloped areas, and 11 responses from employers.**

Regarding **findings of youth in Serbia**, nearly every is either very familiar or at least somewhat familiar with AI tools and **87% use them weekly or more**, mostly for learning/studying (64 %), work tasks (55 %) and content creation (21 %). On the other hand, 58 % answered that they are somewhat confident in their understanding of using AI which is near-universal among respondents from all countries. Despite high usage of artificial intelligence, **91 % of respondents did not have access to AI training or courses**, mentioning diverse barriers such as time, access to training, finance, lack of information or limited local opportunities.

The **greatest fear** is that **AI will replace many jobs** currently available to youth and that AI will increase inequality in the labour market, especially in the IT/digital industry (48 % respondents marked this sector, compared to creative industries, administration, services and manufacturing). The interesting result is that only 3 % marked manufacturing sector as affected one.

Based on survey results on defining most affected groups at risk due to AI influence, **low skilled youth were seen as clearly the most at risk.**

Youth participants identified several **key challenges associated with AI for young people**. These included the **loss of entry-level job opportunities**, the **erosion of critical thinking and independence** through overreliance on AI, the **need for continuous upskilling** to remain competitive in the labour market, and the growing risks posed by **deepfakes and AI-generated disinformation**.

Regarding **findings of employers in Serbia**, it is important to mention that 50 % of the respondents were from digital sectors (IT, digital marketing and similar) and that 40 % of the respondents were from large companies (250+) at senior/supervisor/HR and recruitment positions. Based on survey results, 70 % of respondents use AI tools for daily work, while at the same time **70 % of respondents answered that their companies provide training in AI or digital skills**. As most **important skill of young employees** in era of artificial intelligence, 45 % answered that **problem solving, communication and adaptability** is essential, while 10 % chose AI itself. Interesting score is that 50 % of employers think that young employees are not prepared for labour market and needed skills.

Employers identified several **key challenges** relating to the integration of young people into an AI-driven labour market. These include the need for targeted **education** and training pathways, the **responsible and ethical use of AI tools**, and increased investment in AI and digital literacy. Participants further underlined the importance of **coherent national strategies and sustained public investment to support AI adoption** and ensure the readiness of the future workforce.

Participatory dialogue event findings

The in-situ dialogue complemented the survey findings by allowing participants to explore the experiences and structural factors behind the data. Through the problem tree methodology, participants examined young people's transition into employment, AI-related skills development, and the risks of digital inequalities.

The discussions showed that **the main challenge is not only access to AI tools, but whether young people have the skills, guidance, and opportunities to use AI critically, responsibly, and effectively**. AI was seen as a technology that will primarily transform the nature of work rather than eliminate employment opportunities. Education emerged as a key priority, with participants emphasising that AI literacy should extend beyond young people to include educators, employers, institutions, and the wider population.

Participants identified several risks, including potential job losses in creative sectors, unclear copyright protection for AI-generated content, lack of transparency, environmental impacts, and misuse of AI in areas requiring professional responsibility. The **need for stronger legislation and public awareness was highlighted**, including regulations that protect citizens, ensure responsible AI use, and promote critical thinking from an early age.

During the collective decision-making sessions, participants prioritised the following areas:

Key skills: critical thinking and ethics in AI use, adaptability, basic digital literacy, prompt writing, AI tool-specific skills, and recognising misinformation.

Priority investments: employee training, national investment in AI education, free training opportunities, and the development of an AI skills strategy.

Policy priorities: clear AI regulations, responsible use frameworks, transparency requirements, and data protection measures aligned with GDPR principles.

Overall, participants concluded that preparing for an **AI-driven future requires not only technological access but also education, critical thinking, ethical awareness, and inclusive policies to ensure equal opportunities and responsible AI adoption**.

2.1 Key themes

AI skills and Opportunities: Participants agreed that AI will reshape how work is organised more than it will reduce the overall availability of jobs, shifting the focus towards adaptation and lifelong learning. The decisive factor is not whether young people use AI, but whether they have the skills, guidance, and access needed to engage with it critically and meaningfully. Unequal access to education and digital resources risks widening existing inequalities, making inclusive AI literacy across society a shared priority rather than a youth-specific concern.

Priority skills for an AI-driven labour market: Critical thinking and the ethical evaluation of AI outputs were ranked as the most important competences, ahead of the ability to simply operate AI tools. Adaptability followed closely, reflecting the expectation that both technologies and labour market requirements will continue to evolve. Basic digital literacy was identified as a fundamental prerequisite,

complemented by prompt writing, tool-specific skills, and the ability to recognise misinformation.

Legislative and regulatory frameworks: Participants stressed the responsibility of public authorities to protect citizens from the potential misuse of AI through clear rules defining acceptable use, transparency, and individual rights. Recommendations included AI-specific data protection frameworks drawing on GDPR principles, alongside measures to raise public awareness of the implications of AI use. Throughout, participants sought a balance between enabling responsible innovation and preventing harmful applications, supported by sustained national investment and a comprehensive AI skills strategy.

Risks, ethics, and social concerns: Concerns were raised about the impact of AI-generated content on creative professions, together with the need for clearer rules on copyright, ownership, and the use of creators' materials to train AI systems. Participants emphasised transparency and accountability, including the need to understand how AI systems operate and reach decisions, as well as the environmental footprint associated with their development and use. The misuse of AI was also highlighted, particularly tools that imitate professional support services, such as virtual psychotherapists, without adequate safeguards or oversight.

2.2 Youth perspectives and lived experiences

Young participants described artificial intelligence as an inevitable part of their future education and working lives. Rather than questioning whether AI should be adopted, discussions focused on how young people can adapt to a changing labour market. Participants recognised AI as a valuable tool for productivity, learning, and new professional opportunities, while stressing that these benefits depend on acquiring the necessary digital, AI-related, and transversal skills. On the other hand, young participants expressed significant concerns about their future position in the labour market. The most frequently discussed fears included the declining availability of entry-level jobs, increasing competition for employment, growing skills requirements, and uncertainty regarding the pace of technological change. Many participants believed that future generations will be expected to possess substantially higher levels of AI literacy than previous generations, creating additional pressure on young people entering employment. Participants also highlighted concerns that excessive reliance on AI could reduce creativity, critical thinking, and independent problem-solving if these competencies are not deliberately developed through education.

Ethical concerns featured prominently, particularly regarding the transparency of AI systems, bias in automated decision-making, and unclear responsibility when AI produces harmful outcomes. Participants also raised the environmental dimension, noting that the energy and water consumption required to train and run large models carries a considerable carbon footprint, and argued that sustainability should be treated as an integral part of responsible AI adoption.

Young people agreed that education systems do not adequately prepare them for an AI-driven labour market. They suggested earlier introduction of AI-related learning, more practical opportunities to develop competencies, and investment in educational system. Participants also stressed the importance of lifelong

learning, recognising that continuous reskilling will become a normal requirement throughout their careers rather than an occasional activity.

Overall, young participants recognised that **AI is not a future development but a present reality** already influencing their daily lives, educational choices, and career planning. They acknowledged that **AI is shaping the skills and knowledge required for future employment**. While its impact varies across sectors, participants viewed AI both as a potential challenge to certain occupations and as a valuable tool that can improve efficiency, productivity, and ways of working.

2.3 Employer perspectives

Employers involved in the baseline survey and dialogue highlighted that artificial intelligence is becoming an integral part of the evolving workplace and will have a growing impact on future business processes. They generally perceived AI less as a substitute for human workers and more as a tool that can enhance productivity, streamline operations, automate routine activities, and support more informed decision-making. International and large companies have already incorporated AI tools into their operations and are increasingly providing training opportunities to support employees in their effective use. However, they also noted that AI will influence the structure of jobs and recruitment processes by creating greater demand for workers with advanced digital, analytical, and AI-related skills.

Employers identified several key challenges relating to the integration of young people into an AI-driven labour market. These include the need for targeted education and training pathways, the responsible and ethical use of AI tools, and increased investment in AI and digital literacy.

Overall, both young participants and employers agreed had similar perspectives: Education and effective policy frameworks are critical for successful digital and AI transformation. While education enables individuals to develop the skills needed to adapt to technological change, policies ensure responsible, inclusive, and ethical AI adoption while addressing potential risks and inequalities.

3. Serbian Research Agenda & Action Plan

The participatory research identified several priorities for Serbia. Building on the evidence generated through the baseline survey and participatory dialogue, the following Research Agenda and Action Plan outline the areas that require further attention and practical action.

3.1 Serbian specific key findings

Finding 1 - AI tools are widely used, but essential skills remain underdeveloped

AI is already integrated into young people's everyday informing, learning and working practices. However, a gap remains between the widespread use of AI tools and the level of skills, knowledge, and capacity required to successfully navigate an AI-driven labour market.

Finding 2 - The AI transition depends on dialogue between all stakeholders

The participatory dialogues showed that AI transition should be shared task involving educational institutions, employers, policymakers, civil society and young people. Notably, they also regarded dialogue as an important mechanism of responsible AI governance. Rather than pursuing consensus, participants valued the opportunity to exchange perspectives, question assumptions, and identify common priorities across sectors. This indicates that participatory approaches contribute not only to generating evidence, but also to building the trust, cooperation, and shared understanding required for inclusive and ethical AI adoption.

Finding 3 – Effective AI transformation requires supportive policies and regulatory frameworks

Participants highlighted the need for clear policies and regulatory frameworks to ensure responsible, inclusive, and ethical AI adoption, including transparency, data protection, and protection of citizens' rights. They emphasised that coordinated action between governments, education providers, employers, and other stakeholders is essential to ensure AI development supports innovation, skills development, and equal opportunities.

Finding 4 – AI use in recruitment creates new opportunities and risks for candidate selection

Participants highlighted that the increasing use of AI in recruitment processes can improve efficiency by supporting candidate screening and identifying relevant profiles. However, concerns were raised that reliance on AI-based selection tools may disadvantage qualified candidates whose CVs or professional profiles are not optimised for automated systems, creating a risk that valuable applicants may be excluded at early stages of recruitment.

3.2 Serbian research agenda

Priority theme 1: Strengthening AI literacy and skills

- **Research Objective:** To explore how young people in Serbia can move from frequent, informal use of AI tools towards more structured AI literacy and the skills required by the labour market.
- **Proposed methods/data sources:** Follow-up participatory workshops with young people; surveys, interviews and/or focus groups with youth and employers; comparative analysis across PATHFINDER partner countries; capacity building workshops for youth.
- **Key stakeholders:** Youth (18 – 30), students, youth workers, job info centers, universities, civil society organisations, employers, youth cooperative societies.
- **Youth role(s):** Co-researchers, peer interviewers, participants of the workshops and focus groups, contributing to the identification of skills gaps or validating findings.

- **Timeframe:** Medium term – within the project cycle.

Priority theme 2: Connecting education, employers, and young people in the AI transition

- **Research Objective:** To explore how participatory dialogue and multi-stakeholder cooperation can strengthen young people's transition into an AI-driven labour market, and to identify where such cooperation is currently missing or ineffective.
- **Proposed methods/data sources:** Mapping of existing cooperation mechanisms and their gaps; multi-stakeholder participatory workshops/events; online survey with representatives of universities, employers and experts; consultation meetings with public employment services; focus groups with youth workers and civil society organisations (in-situ or online);
- **Key stakeholders:** Youth (18–30), students, youth workers, youth cooperative societies, universities, employers, civil society organisations, experts, public employment services and job information centres, and relevant public institutions.
- **Youth role(s):** Co-researchers and peer interviewers, participants in workshops and focus groups; contributors to the interpretation of findings and formulation of recommendations, as partners in the process rather than only its subjects.
- **Timeframe:** Long term – within the project cycle.

Priority theme 3: Strengthening policy and governance for inclusive AI adoption

- **Research Objective:** To identify policy options and governance mechanisms that support responsible AI adoption, with particular attention to inequalities in access to education and employment, institutional readiness, and the position of vulnerable groups during technological transformation.
- **Proposed methods/data sources:** Desk analysis (policy and legal framework analysis (national strategies, EU AI Act alignment; consultation meetings with representatives of public institutions and/or regulatory bodies/institutions; comparative review of governance approaches across PATHFINDER partner countries); groups with youth workers and civil society organisations (in-situ or online).
- **Key stakeholders:** Government institutions, regulatory bodies, education authorities, employers, civil society organisations, youth organisations, university, and international organisations.
- **Youth role(s):** Co-creators of recommendations, members of consultation groups, peer facilitators, and participants in policy validation activities.

- **Timeframe:** Long term (within the project cycle).

3.3 Serbian Action Plan for youth-centred change

Drawing on the evidence generated through the baseline survey and the participatory dialogue, the following Action Plan identifies practical actions to support a more inclusive, responsible and youth-centred AI-driven labour-market transition in Serbia.

Action 1: Developing an AI skills pathway for young people

Level: National (with implementation at local level)

Target groups: Young people, employers, career guidance professionals, experts

Resources/supports needed: community support for reaching target groups, collaboration with other stakeholders dealing with youth employment.

Timeline: Medium to long term.

Indicators of change:

- Participants demonstrate improved ability to critically evaluate AI outputs, measured through pre/post assessment.
- Young people take up further AI-related learning after participating in project activities.

Action 2: Building cooperation mechanisms for labour market adaptation

Level: National (with implementation at local level).

Target groups: Youth (18-30), employers, job info centers, public employment services, experts, universities, civil society organizations.

Resources/supports needed: Regular dialogue events, dissemination activities and stakeholder networks, mechanisms for youth participation in decision-making, community support for reaching target groups

Timeline: Long term.

Indicators of change:

- Cooperation mapping completed, with gaps identified.
- New partnerships established through the project.
- Continued multi-stakeholder participation in AI-related dialogue.

Action 3: Developing policy recommendations for inclusive AI adoption

Level: National (aligned with European initiatives where relevant).

Target groups: Government institutions, policymakers, employers, education authorities, youth organisations, youth (18 -30).

Resources/supports needed: Relevant documentation, evidence-based research, policy coordination, stakeholder consultations, awareness-raising activities, guidance on ethical and inclusive AI use.

Timeline: Long term.

Indicators of change:

- AI-related considerations well received at relevant bodies and considered for further policy development
- Increased participation of youth in policy dialogue
- Greater awareness of ethical, inclusive and responsible AI use

4. Annexes

The following annexes provide the supporting materials used during the Serbian participatory research events.

4.1 Agenda (Niš and Belgrade)



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Agenda

AI Mladi, veštačka inteligencija i put do zaposlenja
(WP 5: Participatory research in Serbia)
Belgrade, 17 July 2026
Miljenko Dereta Prostor - Dobračina 55, Beograd

Satnica	Program
09.45 – 10.00	Registracija učesnika
10.00 – 11.30	Prezentacija, upoznavanje učesnika, diskusija
11.30 – 11.45	Pauza
11.45 – 13.30	AI & CV
13.30 – 14.15	Ručak
14.15 – 15.00	AI automatizacija - interaktivna prezentacija
15.00 – 15.15	Pauza
15.15 – 16.00	World cafe
16.00 – 16.15	Evaluacija

Agenda

AI START: Mladi, veštačka inteligencija i put do zaposlenja
(WP 5: Participatory research in Serbia)
8 July 2026
Deli centar - Davidova 2a, Niš

Satnica	Program
09.45 – 10.00	Registracija učesnika
10.00 – 11.15	Prezentacija, upoznavanje učesnika, diskusija
11.15 – 11.30	Pauza
11.30 – 13.00	AI & CV
13.00 – 14.00	Ručak
14.00 – 15.00	Rad u grupama i diskusija (mladi + privatni sektor)
15.00 – 15.15	Pauza
15.15 – 16.00	World cafe (razgovori sa privatnim sektorom)
16.00 – 16.30	Evaluacija

Figure 1. PrtSc of the Agenda in Belgrade (left) and Niš (right) National dialogue event

4.2 National Findings Presentation

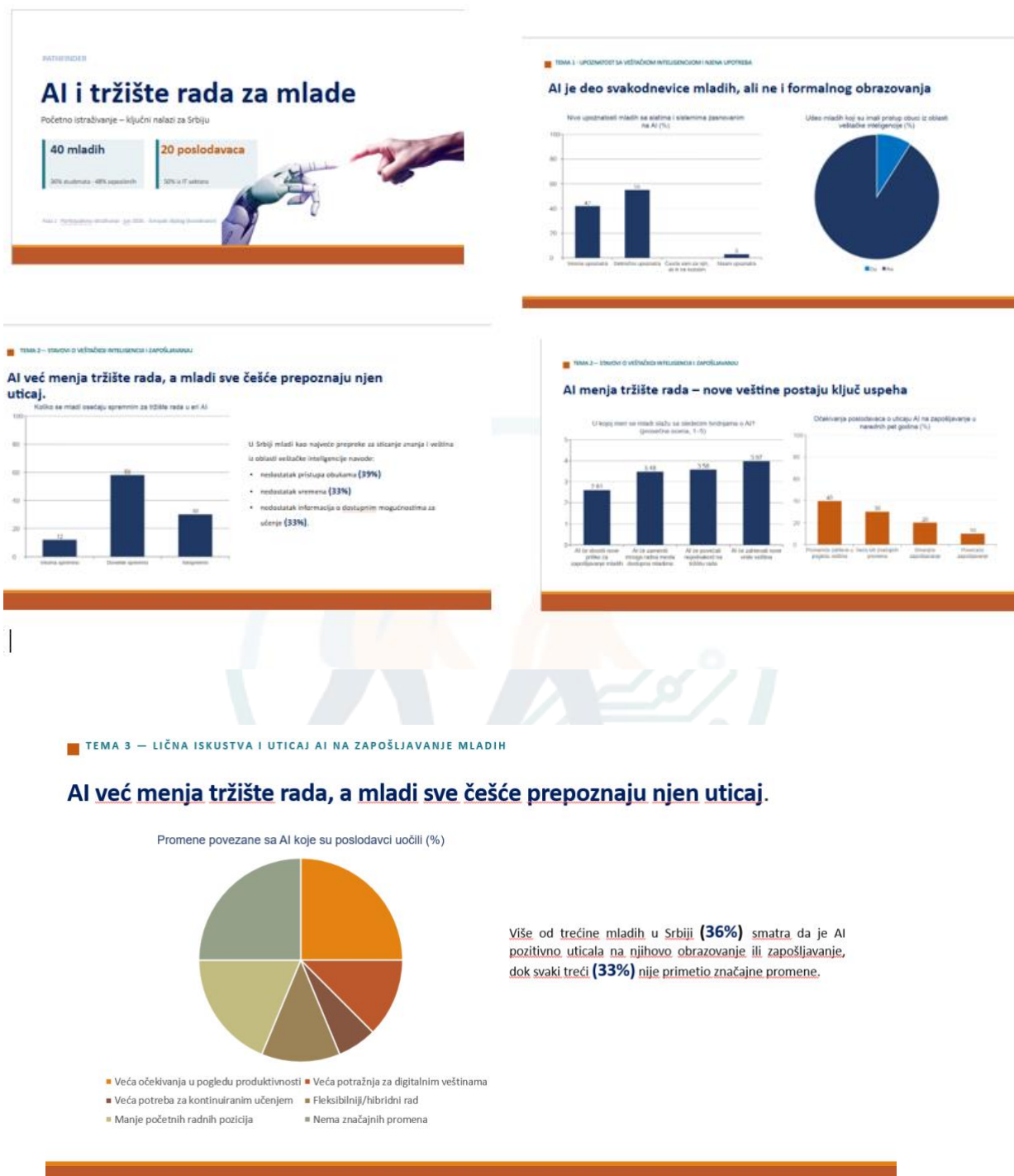


Figure 2. PrtSc of the used presentation (Research findings in Serbia)

4.3 Event photos

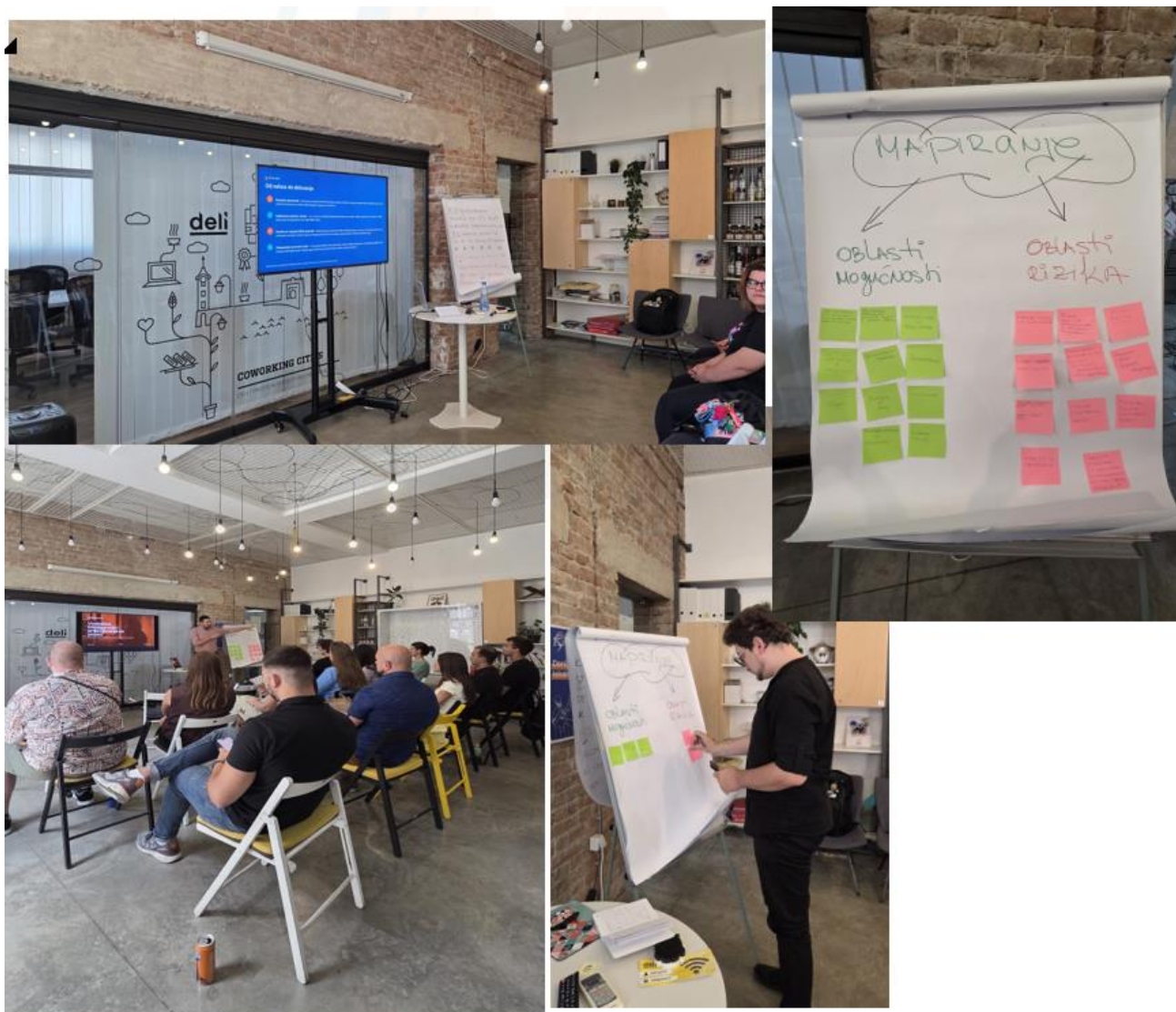


Figure 3. National dialogue event in Niš

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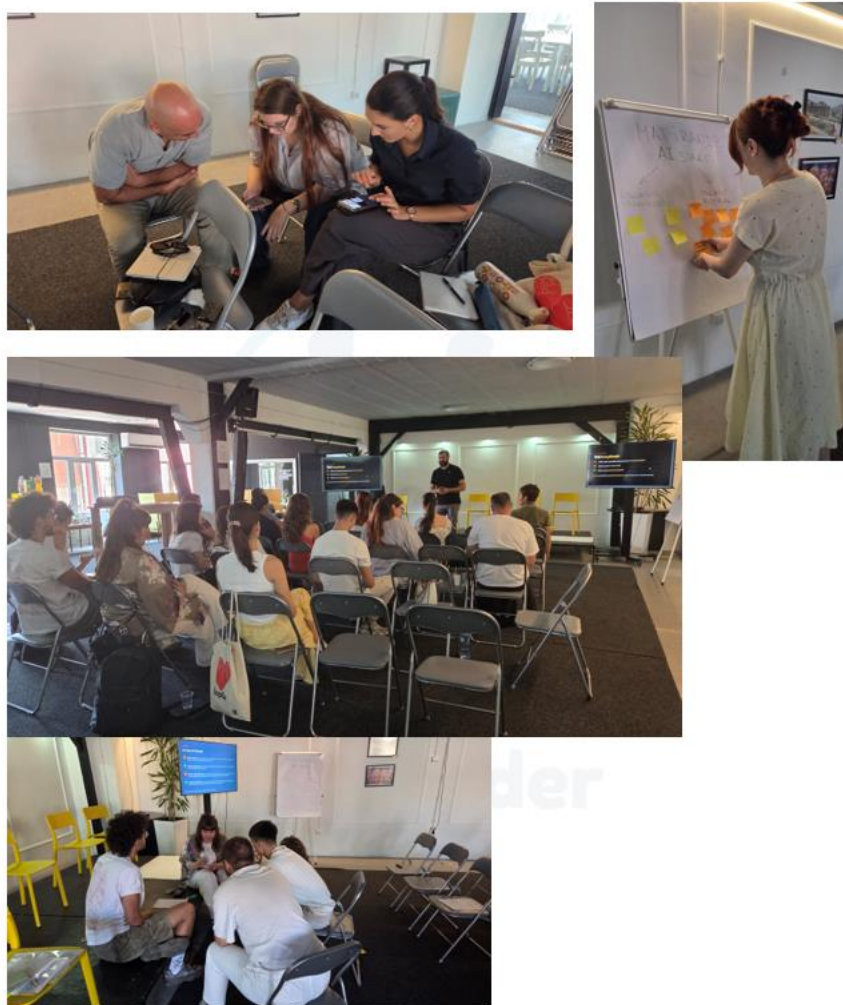


Figure 4. National dialogue event in Belgrade



Figure 5. Focus group – under International Students Week in Belgrade

4.4 Baseline surveys - youth

Section 1 of 8

PATHFINDER – Participativno istraživanje

Prva faza projekta PATHFINDER zasniva se na okviru omladinskog participativnog akcionog istraživanja (YPAR) radi zajedničkog stvaranja znanja o uticaju veštačke inteligencije (AI) na učešće mladih na tržištu rada. Ovaj pristup je u skladu sa principima participativnog akcionog istraživanja kao saradničkog i cikličnog procesa planiranja, delovanja i refleksije, čiji cilj nije samo stvaranje znanja, već i podsticanje društvenih promena. U tom smislu, istraživački proces nije ekstraktivan već transformativan, jer mlade pozicionira kao koistraživače koji ispituju strukturne uslove koji utiču na njihove živote i doprinose oblikovanju odgovora na te izazove.

Više informacija o anketi možete pronaći u [ovom dokumentu](#) i u dokumentu „[Informacije o obradi ličnih podataka](#)“.

Email *

Valid email

This form is collecting emails. [Change settings](#)

Potvrda starosti i ispunjavanja uslova *

Potvrđujem da imam najmanje 18 godina i da ispunjavam uslove za učešće u ovoj anketi.

☐ Da

☐ Ne (ako izaberete „Ne“, anketa se završava)

Potvrda da ste pročitali obaveštenje o privatnosti *

Pročitao/la sam i razumeo/la informacije navedene iznad o načinu obrade mojih ličnih podataka.

☐ Da

☐ Ne

Saglasnost za učešće i obradu ličnih podataka *

Dobrovoljno pristajem da učestvujem u početnoj PATHFINDER anketi i na obradu mojih odgovora u istraživačko suradničkom procesu.

Figure 6. PrtSc of the first page in survey for youth.

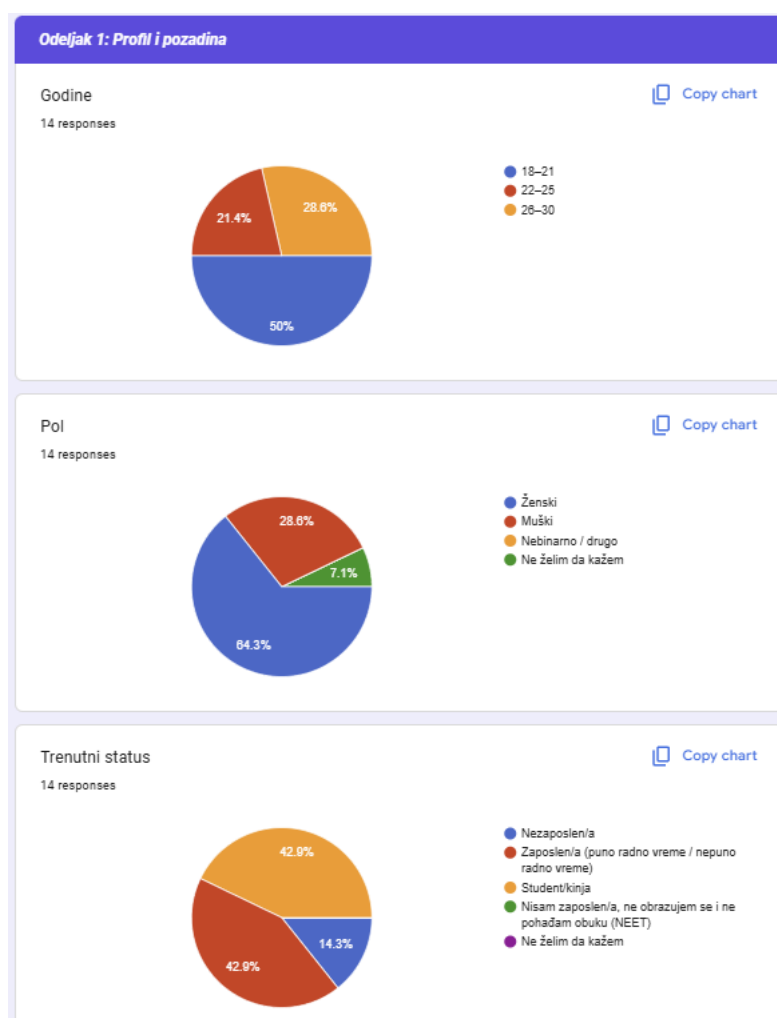


Figure 7. PrtSc of the survey composition (part I)

pathfinder

4.5 Baseline surveys – employers

Section 1 of 8

PATHFINDER – Participativno istraživanje

Prva faza projekta PATHFINDER zasniva se na okviru omladinskog participativnog akcionog istraživanja (YPAR) radi zajedničkog stvaranja znanja o uticaju veštačke inteligencije (AI) na učešće mladih na tržištu rada. Kreiran je upitnik koji popunjavaju mladi koji dolaze iz manje razvijenih sredina u Srbiji, a ovaj upitnik je namenjen poslodavcima sa ciljem da se uvide njihove potrebe i izazovi prilikom zapošljavanja mladih i kako veštačka inteligencija menja proces zapošljavanja, doprinosi automatizaciji dosadašnjih procesa i utiče na odabir kandidata pri zapošljavanju kada su u pitanju kompetence.

Više informacija o anketi možete pronaći u [ovom dokumentu](#) i u dokumentu „[Informacije o obradi ličnih podataka](#)“.

Potvrda da ste pročitali obaveštenje o privatnosti

Pročitao/la sam i razumeo/la informacije navedene iznad o načinu obrade mojih ličnih podataka.

☐ Da

☐ Ne

Saglasnost za učešće i obradu ličnih podataka

Dobrovoljno pristajem da učestvujem u početnoj PATHFINDER anketi i na obradu mojih odgovora u istraživačke svrhe opisane iznad.

☐ Da, pristajem

☐ Ne, ne pristajem (ako izaberete „Ne“, anketa se završava)

After section 1 Continue to next section

Figure 8. PrtSc of the first page in survey for employers

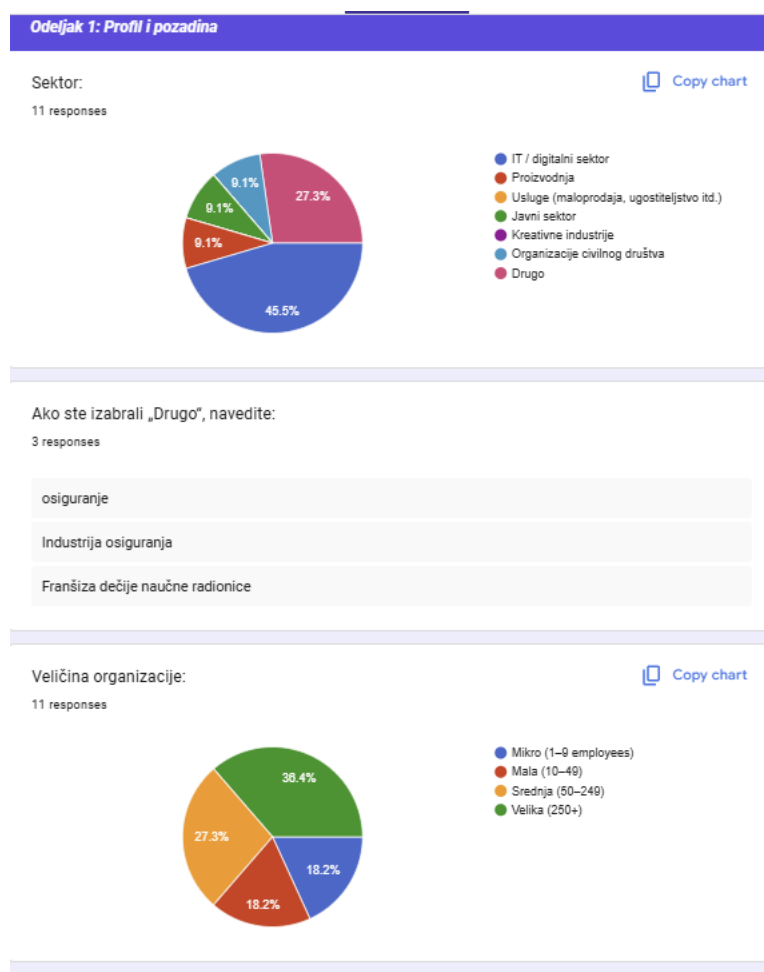


Figure 9. PrtSc of the survey composition

4.6 Social media posts

